DESCRIBING GRAPHS

YOU NEED TO ANSWER (ANY ONE)

Line Graphs

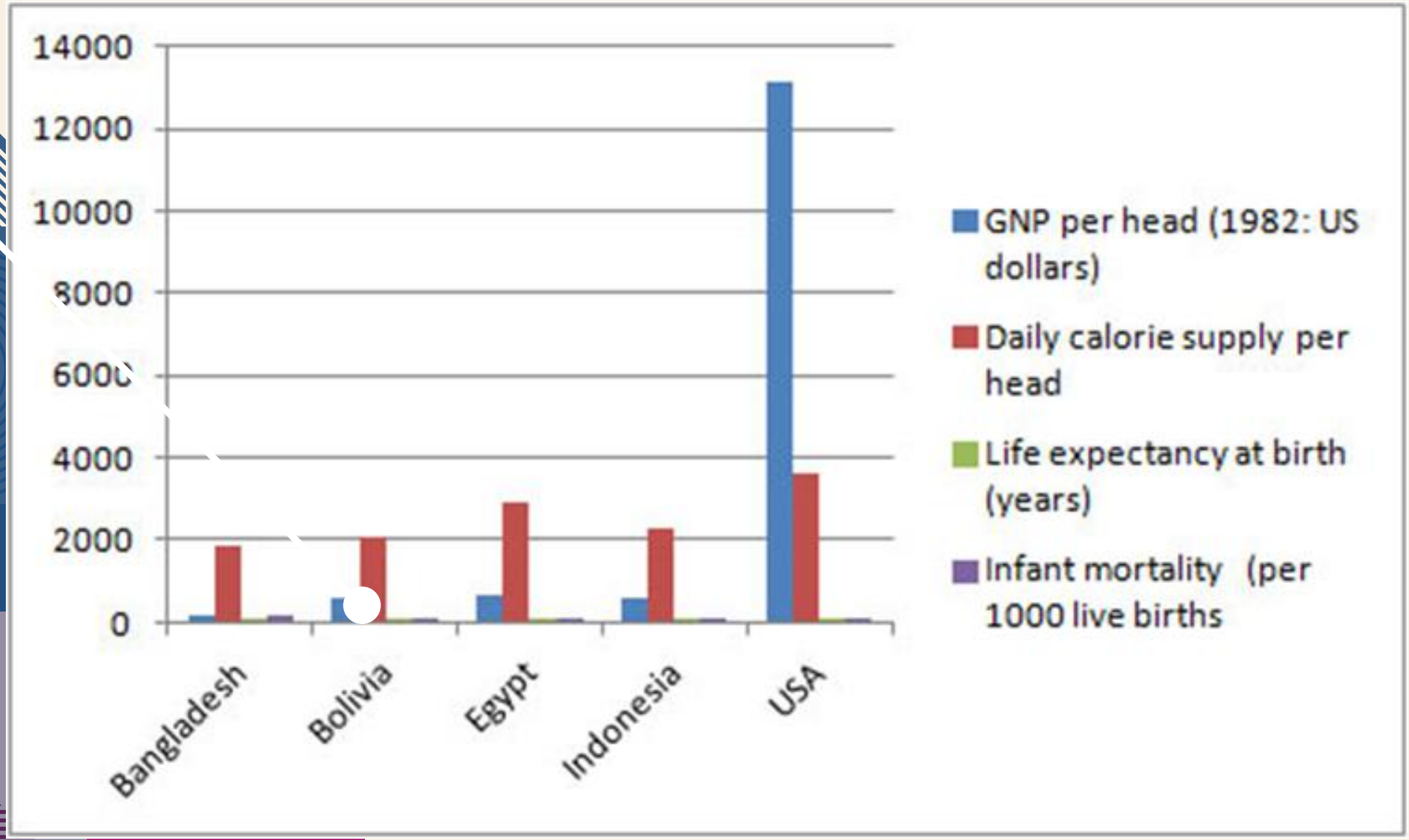
Pie Charts

Table

Bar Graphs

TABLE AND BAR GRAPHS

Country	GNP per head (1982: US dollars)	Daily calorie supply per head	Life expectancy at birth (years)	Infant mortality (per 1000 live births
Bangladesh	140	1877	40	132
Bolivia	570	2086	50	124
Egypt	690	2950	56	97
Indonesia	580	2296	49	87
USA	13160	3653	74	12


14000
12000
10000
8000
6000
4000
2000
0
Bangladesh
Bolivia
Egypt
Indonesia
USA
GNP per head (1982: US dollars)
Daily calorie supply per head
Life expectancy at birth (years)
Infant mortality (per 1000 live births

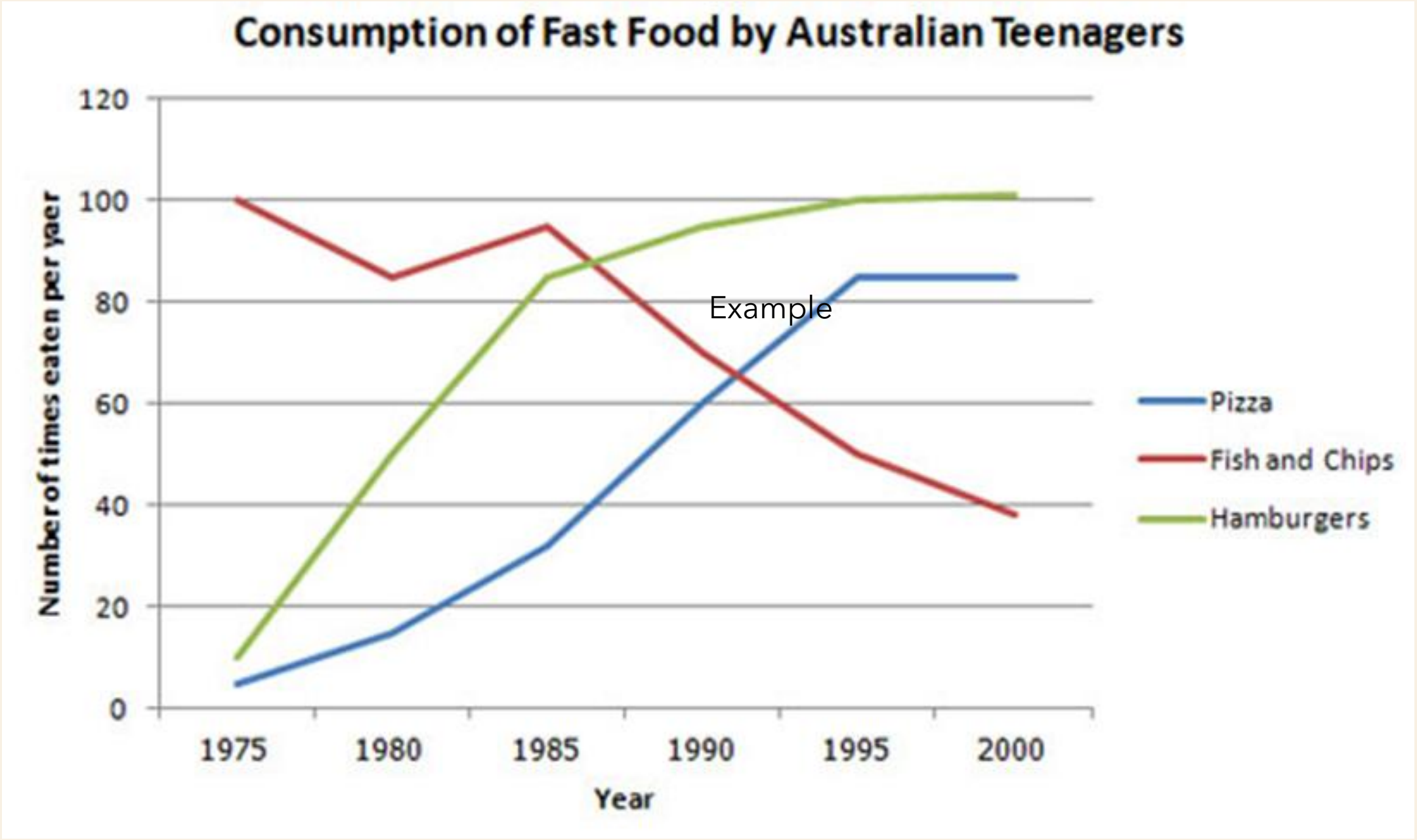


It is better presented as a table because of the huge difference between the USA and the others - this is not very clear on a bar chart.

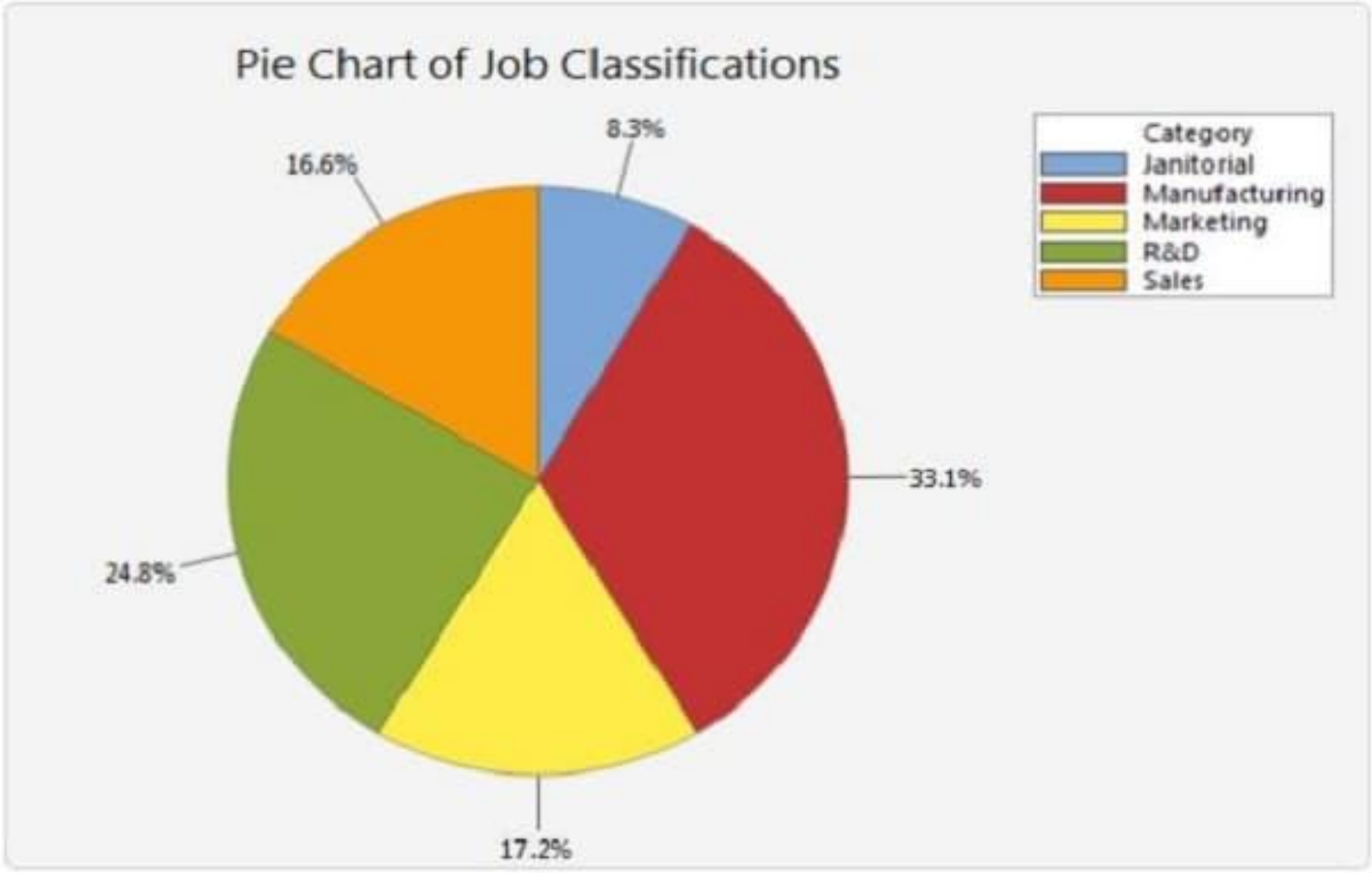
So a table looks better, but they would both be described in exactly the same way.

LINE GRAPH

Enhancing your presentation


Consumption of Fast Food by Australian Teenagers
Number of times eaten per year
120
100
80
60
40
20
0
1975
1980
1985
1990
1995
2000
Year
Example
Pizza
Fish and Chips
Hamburgers

PIE CHART


Pie Chart of Job Classifications
8.3%
16.6%
33.1%
24.8%
17.2%
Category
Janitorial
Manufacturing
Marketing
R&D
Sales

WRITING STRATEGIES

ANALYSING THE TABLE/BAR GRAPHS

Do not describe all the data presented - present the main points of each feature (you should make sure you mention each feature though, e.g. if there are 5 countries, mention every one)

Look for significant data; e.g. the highest, the lowest etc

Try and group the data. This may require you to use some

EFFECTIVE WRITING TECHNIQUES

- Study the graph properly
- Look at the title, time frame, increases and decreases
- Group the information accordingly
- Don’t spend more than 20 minutes on the task
- Write 150 words± 20

EFFECTIVE WRITING TECHNIQUES

- Basic structure of your answer should include:
  1. Introduction: Introduce the graph
  2. Overview: Give an overview
  3. Comparison: Give the details
  4. Word limit 150 ± 20/ Spend 20 minutes

INTRODUCE THE GRAPH

- Example:
- The line graph compares the fast food consumption of teenagers in Australia between 1975 and 2000, a period of 25 years.



You need to begin with one or two sentences that state what the graph shows.



To do this, paraphrase the title of the graph



make sure you are putting in a time frame if there is one.

GIVE THE DETAIL

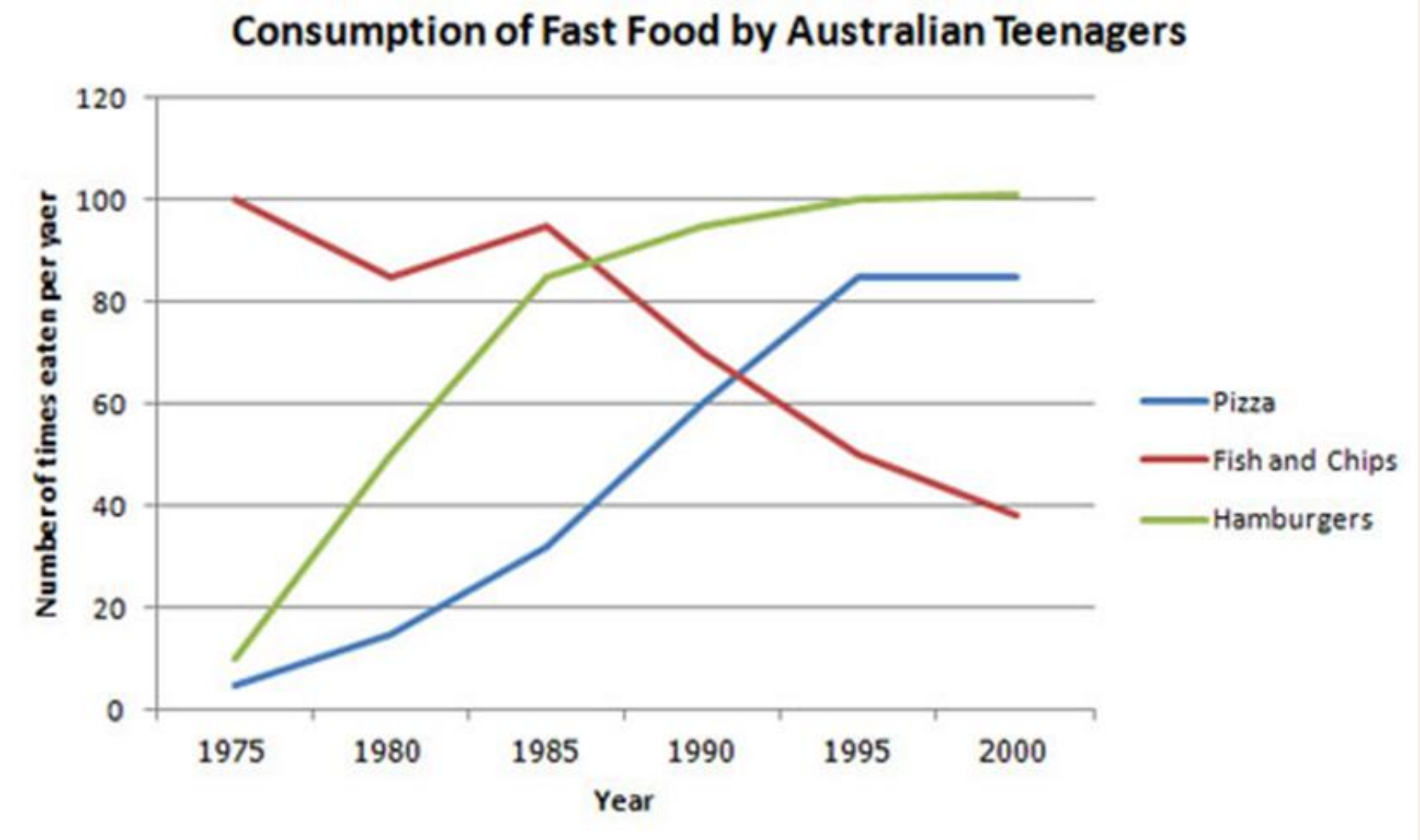
Give the detail in your body paragraphs

You must make references from the graph.

1. Group Data

2. Organize the body paragraphs by grouping the given data together where there are patterns.

3. To group your data identify any similarities and differences


Consumption of Fast Food by Australian Teenagers
120
100
80
60
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Number of times eaten per year
1975
1980
1985
1990
1995
2000
Year
Pizza
Fish and Chips
Hamburgers

LOOK AT THE GRAPH :

[WHAT THINGS ARE SIMILAR & WHAT THINGS ARE DIFFERENT?]

As we have already identified in the overview, the consumption of fish and chips declined over the period, whereas the amount of pizza and hamburgers that were eaten increased.

- So it is clear that pizza and hamburgers were following a similar pattern,
- but fish and chips were different.
- On this basis, you can use these as your ‘groups’, and focus one paragraph on fish and chip and the other one on pizza and hamburgers.

EXAMPLE OF THE FIRST PARAGRAPH:

In 1975, the most popular fast food with Australian teenagers was fish and chips, being eaten 100 times a year. This was far higher than Pizza and hamburgers, which were consumed approximately 5 times a year. However, apart from a brief rise again from 1980 to 1985, the consumption of fish and chips gradually declined over the 25 years timescale to finish at just under 40.

THE SECOND PARA FOCUSES ON THE OTHER INFORMATION:

In sharp contrast to this, teenagers ate the other two fast foods at much higher levels. Pizza consumption increased gradually until it overtook the consumption of fish and chips in 1990. It then levelled off from 1995 to 2000. The biggest rise was seen in hamburgers as the occasions they were eaten increased sharply throughout the 1970's and 1980's, exceeding that of fish and chips in 1985. It finished at the same level that fish and chips began, with consumption at 100 times a year.

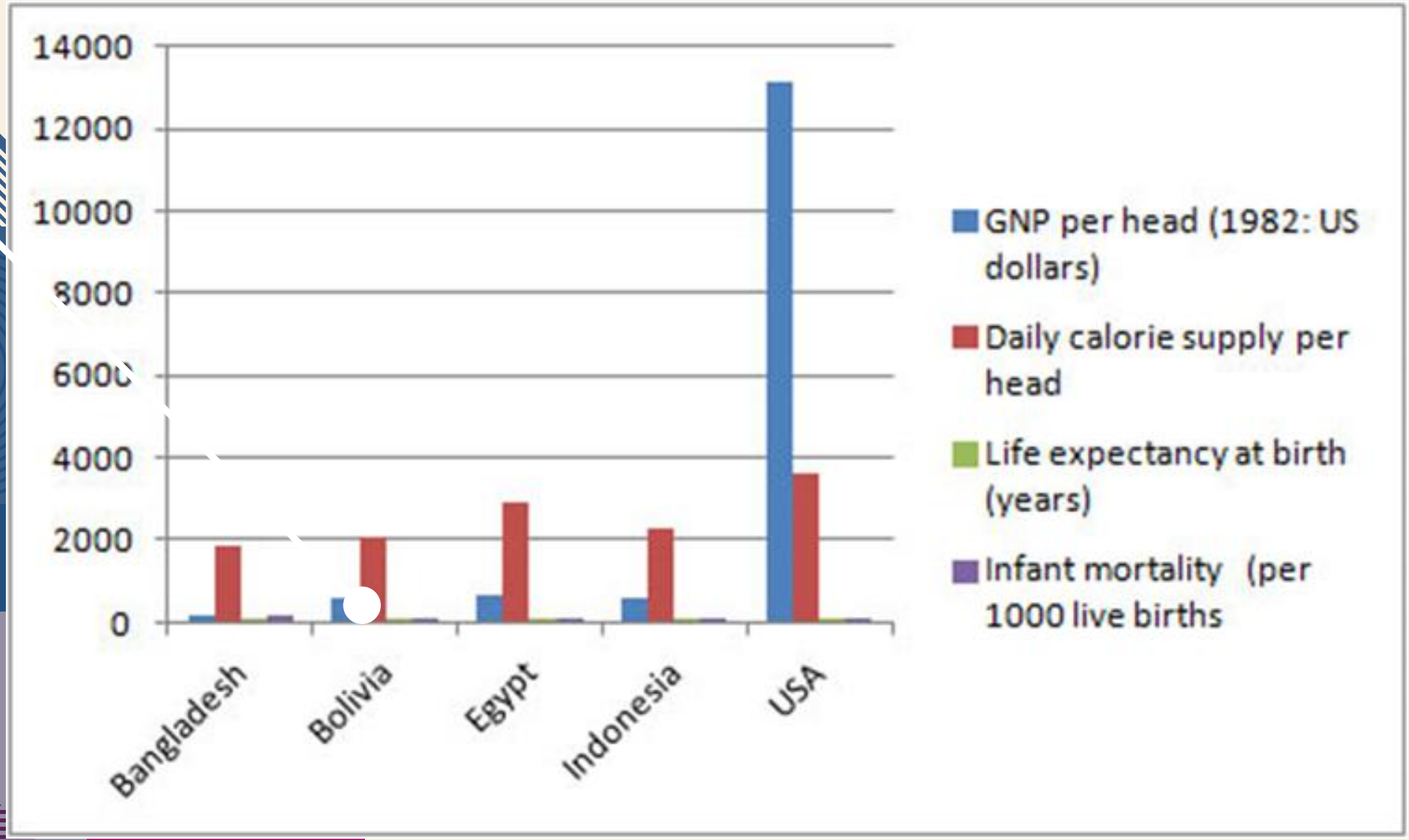
ANSWER:

- The line graph compares the fast food consumption of teenagers in Australia between 1975 and 2000, a period of 25 years. Overall, the consumption of fish and chips declined over the period, whereas the amount of pizza and hamburgers that were eaten increased.
- In 1975, the most popular fast food with Australian teenagers was fish and chips, being eaten 100 times a year. This was far higher than Pizza and hamburgers, which were consumed approximately 5 times a year. However, apart from a brief rise again from 1980 to 1985, the consumption of fish and chips gradually declined over the 25 year timescale to finish at just under 40.
- In sharp contrast to this, teenagers ate the other two fast foods at much higher levels. Pizza consumption increased gradually until it overtook the consumption of fish and chips in 1990. It then levelled off from 1995 to 2000. The biggest rise was seen in hamburgers as the occasions they were eaten increased sharply throughout the 1970's and 1980's, exceeding that of fish and chips in 1985. It finished at the same level that fish and chips began, with consumption at 100 times a year.

TABLE

Model Answer

Country	GNP per head (1982: US dollars)	Daily calorie supply per head	Life expectancy at birth (years)	Infant mortality (per 1000 live births
Bangladesh	140	1877	40	132
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GNP per head (1982: US dollars)
Daily calorie supply per head
Life expectancy at birth (years)
Infant mortality (per 1000 live births

PLAN YOUR ANSWER

- You should always ask yourself these kind of questions before you write about a graph. You can then use the answer to these questions to make yourself a quick plan.
- Topic – standard of living, 5 countries
- Language – comparison
- Time / tense – 1982 = past
- Overview – USA far higher
- Groups –
    - USA = highest
    - Egypt, Indo, Bol = similar
    - Bangladesh = very low

MODEL ANSWER:

- The table uses four economic indicators to show the standard of living in five selected countries in 1982. Overall, it can be seen that the quality of life in the USA was far higher than the other four countries.
- To begin, the USA, which is a developed country, had the highest GNP at 13,160 dollars per head. It also had a much higher daily calorie intake and life expectancy, and the lowest rate of infant mortality, at only 12 per 1000 live births.
- Quality of life was much lower for the other four countries. The indicators for Egypt, Indonesia and Bolivia were fairly similar, with their GNP ranging from 570 to 690 and daily calories in the 2000s. Life expectancy was also almost the same, although Bolivia had much worse infant mortality at 124 per 1000.
- Bangladesh had by far the lowest quality of life in all the indicators. Its GNP per head was approximately one percent of the USA's. Its calorie intake and life expectancy were about half those of the USA, and its infant mortality rate was 11 times greater.

DESCRIBING PIE CHART

STRUCTURE YOUR WRIITNG

1. Introduction (Just take the information from the question card and paraphrased it)

a.what your graph shows

b.for what period of time

2. General Overview

a. find the biggest and smallest slices of each pie chart

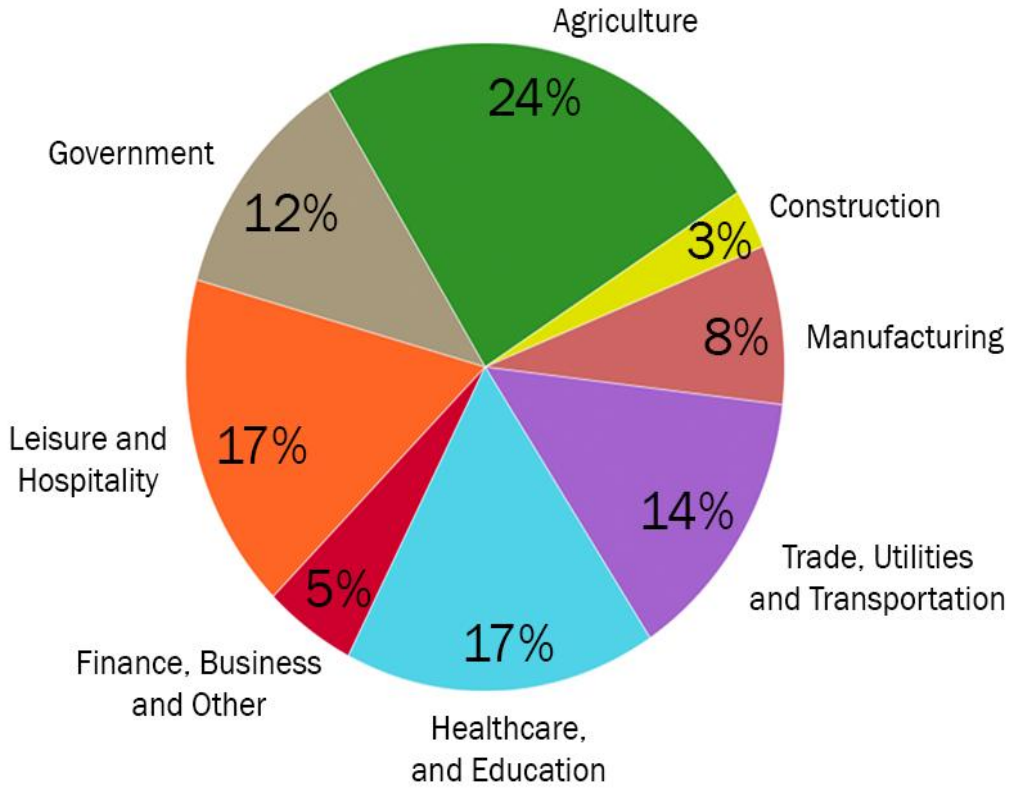
b. find which slices became bigger/smaller or didn't change

3. Specific details (Compare & Contrast)

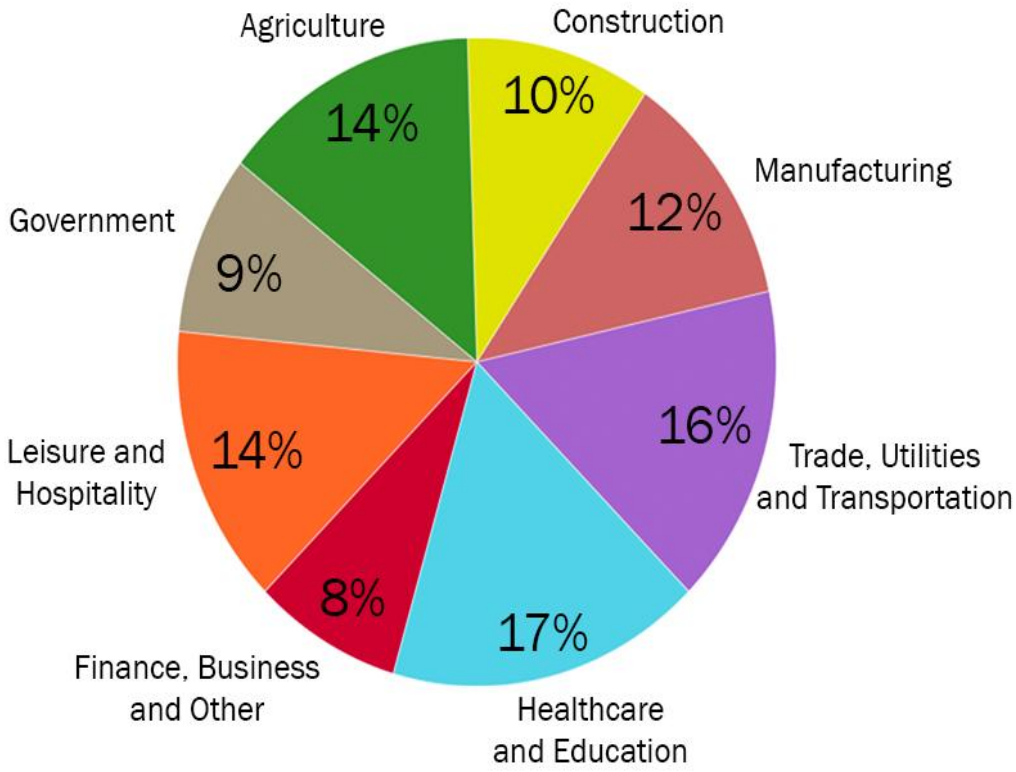
a.Sectors that had an *increase* (construction; trade utilities & transportation; manufacturing; finance, business and other services)

b.Sectors that had a *decrease or didn't change* (agriculture; government; leisure and hospitality; healthcare and education)

Contribution to the economy of Turkey by sector



2000



2016

EXAMPLE ANSWER

- Introduction:
  - The two pie charts illustrate how different industry sectors contributed to the economy of Turkey percentagewise in the years 2000 and 2016.
- Overview:
  - Overall, at the beginning of the period construction contributed the least to the economy of Turkey and agriculture was the most significant economic sector. In comparison, at the end of the period healthcare and education became the largest economic segment and the lowest contribution was made by financial, business and other services.

- Comparison
  - Construction sector accounted for 3% of Turkey's economy in 2000, and experienced a more than threefold increase to one-tenth in 2016. Economic income from trade, utilities and transportation was 14% in 2000 and experienced a slight growth of 2% in 2016. At the beginning of the period, manufacturing and finance, business and other services made up 8% and 5% of Turkey's economy, respectively, and these figures rose to 12% and 8% in 2016.
  - Agriculture, which comprised almost a quarter of Turkey's economy in 2000, fell to 14% in 2016. In 2000 economic outputs from government and leisure and hospitality sectors were at 12% and 17%, respectively, and both decreased by 3% after 16-year period. In contrast, contribution from healthcare and education sector remained constant in both years at 17%.

VOCABULARY AND SENTENCES FOR GRPAH

VERBS TO DESCRIBE THE TRENDS

- **Increase**
- **Surge**
- **Grow**
- **Peak**
- **Show an upward trend**
- **Double**
- **Triple**
- **Rocket**
- **Rise**
- **Shoot up**
- **Recover**

Drop

Show a downward trend

Fall

Decline

Decrease

Dip

ADVERBS

- Now we add adverbs to the verbs, ie "how?"
  - Significantly
  - Remarkably
  - Dramatically
  - Sharply
  - Gradually
  - Steadily
  - Marginally (=slightly)
  - Negligibly (=very slightly)

NOW ADD VERB + ADVERB

- Decrease Considerably
- Decline Slightly
- Fall Gradually
- Drop Steadily
- Rise Sharply
- Increase Dramatically

EXAMPLE SENTEMCES

Vocabulary	Example Sentence
Increase	The sales figures exhibited a consistent increase over three months.
Rise	Stock prices experienced a significant rise during the first quarter.
Grow	The company's revenue continued to grow month by month.
Climb	The temperature climbed to 30 degrees Celsius in the afternoon
Upward Trend	There is an upward trend in the number of students enrolling at the university.
Decline	The quality of the product declined over time.
Drop	Sales dropped suddenly in the last week of the month.
Decrease	The number of accidents on the road decreased after speed limits were enforced.
Fall	The temperature fell rapidly as the sun set.

EXAMPLE SENTEMCES

Vocabulary	Example Sentence
Fluctuate	Prices of commodities tend to fluctuate daily due to market changes.
Remain Stable	The population of the city has remained stable for the past decade.
Level Off	After a period of rapid growth, sales leveled off in the last quarter.
Peak	The demand for the product peaked during the holiday season.
Bottom Out	Housing prices seem to have bottomed out after a long period of decline.
Recover	The economy is expected to recover after a sharp decline.
Sustain	The growth in the tech industry has been sustained over the years.
Plateau	The number of tourists visiting the city plateaued at around 2 million per year.

ADVANCED VOCABULARY FOR PARAPHRASING FIGURES

2% = a very small proportion of

2-10% = a mere 3 percent OR a mere 5 percent of

16% = a small minority

20% = a fifth

24% = almost a quarter

25% = a quarter

26% = roughly one quarter

32% = nearly one-third

35% = more than a third

49% = just under a half

50% = a half

51% = just over a half

55% = more than half

70% = a large proportion of

72% = a significant majority of

73% = nearly three quarters

76% = just over three-qua

ADD THESE WORDS TO THE FIGURES

- Just around
- Just about
- Just below
- A little more than
- A little less than

Approximately

Nearly

Roughly

Almost

Just over

Just under

PREPOSITIONS

- By 1978
- Over a twelve-year period
- In the last year
- Over the next three years
- In the following year
- Over the period in question
- At the beginning/end of the period
- Throughout the period in question, In the first half of the decade …
- An Increase of 30%.
- Decreased by 15%
- Rose sharply over a period of 10 years

- https://yourielts.net/prepare-for-ielts/ielts-vocabulary/ielts-writing-task-1-vocabulary
- https://www.learnenglishteam.com/vocabulary-for-describing-graphs-and-charts-ielts/